PROJECT PAPER · [DATE]

Tagpool

A place where everyone's photos, video, and audio from the same night end up together — without anyone organising it.

01

In one paragraph

When you photograph a concert, your pictures go into your phone and stay there. So do everyone else's. Two thousand people were at that show and they each hold a fragment of it, permanently separated. Tagpool asks uploaders for three things — **who** was playing, **where** it was, and **when** — and uses those to pool everyone's media onto a single page for that night. Nobody creates an event. Nobody invites anyone. Tagging the same place and date as a stranger is what puts you in the same room as them.

WHO	WHERE	WHEN
Aimee Mann	**Eau Claire Festival**	**24 July 2026**

A working version is live today. It is a prototype with no users yet, and this paper is candid about that.

02

The problem

Live events generate enormous quantities of amateur media and almost no shared memory. The footage exists — it's just scattered across thousands of camera rolls with no way to find each other.

Where it does surface, it surfaces as broadcast. You post your clip to Instagram, your followers see it, and it disappears down the feed. The people it would mean most to — the other two thousand who were standing there — never see it, because social platforms are organised around *who you know*, not *where you were*.

> The information needed to connect these people already exists in every upload. Nobody collects it in a form that lets uploads find each other.

This gets worse with time. A photo of CBGB in 1975 is far more interesting alongside forty others from the same year than it is alone, and there is currently nowhere for it to go and find them.

03

The insight

Tags on most platforms are decoration — free text, unlimited, used for reach. Here they are *structure*, and three design decisions make them work where hashtags don't.

Tags are typed, not freeform

Every tag is a performer, a place, or a topic. Namespacing means a venue can't collide with a band of the same name, and it lets the browse interface ask coherent questions: *everything from this place*, *everything on this day*.

Identity is the normalized form, not what was typed

"Aimee Mann", "aimee mann", and "AIMEE MANN" are one tag. Without this, pooling fails — and fails *invisibly*, because each person sees their own upload sitting alone and concludes nobody else posted. The system that looks like it has no users and the system whose tags fragmented are indistinguishable from the inside.

A moment is a place on a day

Not a performer, a place, and a day. The performer is optional, which matters more than it sounds: a photo of an empty CBGB storefront has no performer and would never pool with anything, and a festival with forty bands would fracture into forty separate pages instead of one afternoon. Performers live *inside* a moment as filters.

> Moments are never created by anyone. They are derived — the observation that several people independently tagged the same place and the same date. A moment comes into existence the instant the second person tags correctly, and needs no organiser, no invitation, and no coordination.

04

What exists today

There is a healthy category of event photo-sharing tools — DropEvent, Kululu, GUESTPIX, Eventer and others. Every one of them works the same way: **an organiser creates an album and invites guests**, usually by QR code. They are built for weddings and corporate events, where somebody is in charge and the guest list is known.

That model cannot serve the case here. Nobody is in charge of a Tuesday night at a club. There is no guest list, no organiser, and no moment at which two strangers agree to share an album.

APPROACH	HOW PEOPLE CONNECT	GAP
Event album apps DropEvent, Kululu, GUESTPIX	An organiser invites guests	Requires somebody in charge and a known guest list
Instagram, TikTok	Followers	Organised by who you know, not where you were; content decays in hours
Google / Apple shared albums	You invite specific people	Private by construction; strangers can never join
Reddit, fan forums	Manual posting into threads	Text-first, no media structure, dies when the thread does
Tagpool	**Tagging the same place and date**	**Depends on people tagging accurately — the core risk**

The wedge is narrow and specific: this is the only model where two people who have never met, and never coordinated, end up in the same place because they were at the same event.

05

What is built

This is not a concept. A complete working product is deployed and running:

- **Upload** of photos, video, and audio, with thumbnails, video poster frames, and audio waveforms generated automatically
- **Faceted tagging** with type-ahead that steers people onto existing tags, and normalization underneath as a safety net
- **Dates read from the photo itself** where the camera recorded one, removing the field people are most likely to skip or mistype
- **Automatic pooling** into moment pages, with performer filters inside them
- **Faceted browse** — pick any combination of performer, place, date, and topic
- **Likes, comments on both photos and whole moments, and following** of tags and moments, with a personalised home feed
- **Editing** of tags and details after posting, without losing accumulated likes and comments
- **Moderation** — reporting, a review queue, reversible hiding, account suspension, and tag management

- **Invite-gated signup**, rate limiting, and published house rules and takedown process

> Built to be cheap to run and cheap to move. Storage and database both sit behind adapters, so the path from a $5/month host to object storage and managed Postgres is configuration rather than a rewrite.

06

Why this could matter

Live music alone is enormous and growing. Live Nation — one company, not the market — reported these figures for 2025:

159M	55,000	$25.2B
fans attending, up 5% year on year	shows worldwide	revenue, up 9%

Nearly every one of those attendees carries a camera and uses it. The media already exists; none of it is pooled. And concerts are only the obvious case — the same structure fits festivals, protests, sports, parades, and neighbourhoods over time.

> **Be careful with this number.** Attendance is not a market size, and no investor should read it as one. It establishes that the behaviour is widespread, nothing more. The honest position is that this is an unproven consumer product in a large space, not a company with a measurable addressable market.

07

How it would grow

The mechanic is unusual and worth being precise about, because it is the main argument for the idea:

1. Someone uploads a photo and tags it with a place and a date
2. They find other people's photos of the same night already there
3. They tell people who were with them — *there are photos from that show*
4. Those people upload theirs, and the pool deepens

Every upload makes the corresponding moment more valuable to everyone else who was there, which is a real network effect. But it is a network effect with an unusually high floor: **the first person to tag a night finds nothing**, and has no reason to come back. Solving that cold start is the central product problem, not a growth detail.

The most likely first move is to seed narrowly — one scene, one venue, one festival — so a newcomer's first search actually returns something.

08

Money

There is no revenue today and no proven model. Being straight about that is more useful than a projection. The plausible directions, roughly in order of how natural they feel:

- **Venues and festivals** paying for a branded page for their events — the archive is marketing material they currently don't have
- **Artists** paying for an official pooled archive of a tour
- **Subscriptions** for heavy uploaders: original-quality storage, bulk upload, downloads
- **Print and physical goods** from a night you were at

> None of this matters until pooling demonstrably works. A product where strangers reliably find each other's photos has many ways to make money; one where they don't has none.

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Where it actually stands

Live deployed and publicly reachable	**0** users outside the builder	**$0** revenue, and no model tested

The product is real and complete enough to use. Nothing about whether people *will* use it has been tested. The immediate next step is putting it in front of a small invited group and watching for one specific thing: whether two people who don't know each other independently tag the same night.

That single observation is worth more than any amount of further building.

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What could go wrong

Anyone considering putting money in deserves these stated plainly.

People may not tag accurately

The entire product rests on it. Normalization and type-ahead reduce the problem but cannot solve indifference. If people tag lazily, uploads don't pool, and the core promise silently fails. This is the risk that matters most and it is not yet tested.

Cold start

An empty moment page gives a first visitor no reason to return. Every pooling product faces this; many die of it.

Recordings carry real rights problems

A recording of a performance involves the performer, the songwriter, and often the venue. Most artists do not permit taping. A site pooling concert audio should expect takedown notices, and it has a takedown process for that reason — but this is a genuine ongoing exposure, not a theoretical one.

Moderation is a permanent cost

Any open media platform attracts material that must be removed. Tools exist; the labour they imply does not go away, and it scales with success.

A large platform could copy the mechanic

Instagram could group by location and date tomorrow. The defence is not technology — it is being the place people expect this to work, and the archive that accumulates there.

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Who is building it

[YOUR BACKGROUND — what you have done before, why you specifically care about live music and its documentation, and what makes you the person who keeps going at this after the novelty wears off. For a friends-and-family raise this is the section that actually does the work; people are backing you, not a market analysis.]

[WHO ELSE IS INVOLVED, if anyone — collaborators, advisors, people who have promised time. If it is only you, say so; that is a fact, not a weakness, at this stage.]

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What I’m asking for

[AMOUNT you are raising and the structure — for friends and family this is commonly a SAFE or a simple convertible note. Get a lawyer to paper it however small it is; informal money between people who care about you is exactly where clarity is worth most.]

[WHAT IT BUYS — be concrete and modest. Hosting is a few hundred dollars a year at this stage, so the money is really buying your time, and possibly design or legal help. Say how many months of runway and what you intend to have learned by the end of it.]

> **The honest framing for this round.** This is not a company with traction seeking growth capital. It is a working product and a specific bet, seeking enough runway to find out whether the bet is right. Anyone putting money in should treat it as money they can afford to lose, and you should say that to them out loud rather than leaving it implied.

APPENDIX

How it works

For readers who want the mechanics. The interesting parts are all in how tags are modelled — everything else is ordinary web software.

Tag identity

Every tag has a display label and a normalized slug. The slug is the identity: case folded, whitespace collapsed, punctuation and accents stripped. “Aimee Mann”, “aimee mann”, “AIMEE MANN”, and “Aimée Mann” all resolve to `aimee-mann`, so four people typing carelessly still land in one pool. A uniqueness constraint on `(facet, slug)` makes duplicates impossible rather than merely unlikely.

Dates are a column, not a tag

This is the least obvious decision and the most important. As a tag, “July 24th”, “7/24”, “24 July 2026”, and “2026-07-24” are four separate values and a pool splits four ways. As a real date column it is one value, it sorts, and it supports range queries a tag never could. The interface still shows it as a chip beside the others, so the distinction is invisible to users.

Moments are derived

No moment is ever stored. The moment page for a place and a date is a grouped query across uploads carrying that place tag and that date:

```
GROUP BY where_tag, event_date
```

The consequence is that a moment exists the instant the second person tags correctly — no backfill, no event records to maintain, and no state to keep in sync. Correcting a mistagged date silently relocates a photo into the right moment with nothing to migrate.

Filtering

Or within a facet, *and* across facets. Two performers means either performer; a performer plus a venue plus a date means all three. Selecting a performer alone returns everything of theirs; adding the venue and date narrows to one show. The progressive narrowing that makes browse feel navigable falls out of that single rule.

Stack

Next.js and Postgres, with images processed on upload and ffmpeg generating video poster frames and audio waveforms. Media storage sits behind an interface with local-disk and S3-compatible implementations, so moving to Cloudflare R2 — which charges nothing for bandwidth, the cost that dominates a video site — is an environment variable rather than a migration. Development runs against an embedded Postgres, so a new contributor needs no database installed and no accounts.

Tagpool · [YOUR NAME] · [EMAIL] · [LIVE URL]

Live Nation 2025 figures from the company's reported full-year results. Everything stated about the product's status is current as of the date above and describes a prototype with no users.